THE LEGAL STRATEGIST

Nyrika Holkar, *41*
Executive Director, Godrej & Boyce

NYRIKA HOLKAR IS A FOURTH-GENERATION member of the illustrious Mumbai-based Godrej family. After starting her career at the legal firm AZB & Partners, where she specialised in mergers and acquisitions (M&As) and advised foreign companies seeking to invest in India, she joined Godrej & Boyce (G&B), a multi-commercial service provider with a 125-year-long rich legacy.

Niece of G&B chairman & managing director Jamshyd Godrej, Nyrika was appointed to the board of directors in 2017. Today, she drives a company-wide strategy for building new digital interventions through online platforms and ecosystems to help improve customer experience, foster collaborative innovation, and enhance data-led decision-making in business. A qualified solicitor, Nyrika is responsible for the company's global legal strategy, including supervising commercial contracts, structuring M&A transactions as well as protecting and enhancing the organisation's intellectual property across its 14 businesses.

The shift in consumer preferences post the Covid-19 pandemic towards larger, premium products drove her to push teams to design better products, including refrigerators, smart appliances and locks. She also reportedly led a drive to modernise the organisational architecture and digital assets. Powered by such initiatives, G&B revenues saw an 18 per cent rise from Rs 12,500 crore in FY22 to Rs 14,796 crore in FY23.

Married with two kids, for Nyrika motherhood has been a big learning experience. "I feel I have learnt a lot from my daughter in terms of the importance of listening and how to communicate in a clear and effective manner," she says. It means being more open to reassessing her preconceived notions and realising the importance of looking at things from other people's perspectives.

Under her watch, G&B has forged many technology partnerships in recent times such as with IIT Madras-incubated start-up Tvasta for 3D printing in construction. Nyrika believes in empowering people, especially the women in her office. The word 'power', for her, means the ability to carry people along and to be influential in a meaningful way. "Women do have different priorities, and at the end of the day at home, the buck does stop with them," she says. "My priority is to introduce mechanisms so that women in junior roles stay, and eventually take up leadership roles." ■

–M.G. Arun & Prerna Lidhoo



MILIND SHELTE

LEADING LIGHT

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ACCOMPLISHMENT
A qualified solicitor, she has led G&B's multiple technology partnerships and enhanced intellectual property across its 14 businesses

ONE WITH NATURE
A yoga practitioner and a runner, Nyrika also likes reading, hiking and photography